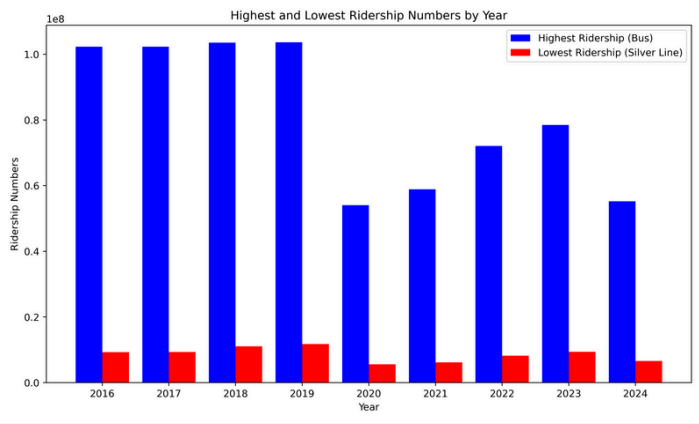
RIDERSHIP

SOURCE: MBTA MONTHLY RIDERSHIP BY MODE

The bus has consistently had the highest ridership numbers every year since 2016. Out of bus and subway options, the Silver Line has conversely shown the lowest ridership numbers.



The bus predominantly serves lower income and minority communities, who are proven to need access to public transportation the most.

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

- People who live in low income and racially diverse areas, where the predominant mode of transportation is the Bus, use public transportation in Boston the most.
- The Silver Line serves wealthier communities like Seaport, as well as the airport, and is used the least frequently because it is not needed as much there.

A DISCONNECTED T: WHO BENEFITS FROM THE MBTA?



PROBLEM:

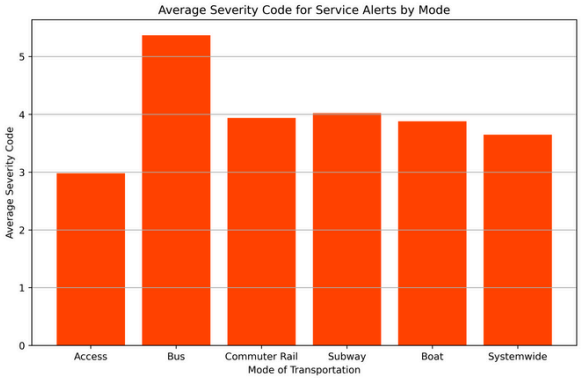
Public transportation in the United States knowingly underserves the population who needs access to it the most: low income and minority populations. 45% of Americans do not have access to public transportation, even though it is beneficial to everyone. Home prices are up to 24% more near public transportation, and governments prioritize the gas and oil industry over the public good of public transportation. This leads people to have less access and ability to do certain things, including go to work and school.

ISSUES

SOURCE: MBTA SERVICE ALERTS

The mode of transportation in the MBTA that experiences the most service alerts every year since 2019 has been the Bus. The Bus also has the worst average severity code (how bad the delay is) out of all the types of transportation.

Additionally, throughout the entire dataset there are 157,786 delays on record that took up to 20 minutes or more. That is a total of at least 6 years worth of waiting due to delays, within the timeframe of the data.



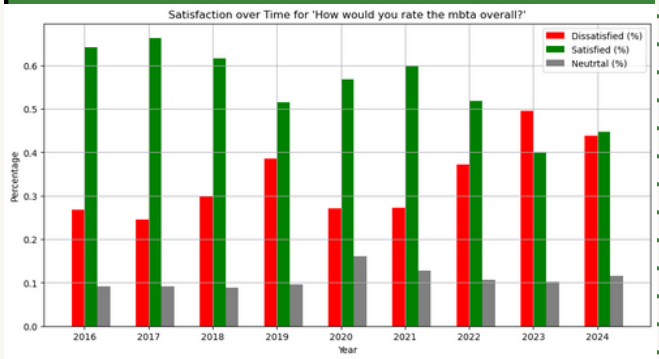
The most frequent cause for the Bus service alerts is traffic. While traffic is always going to be an issue with ground transportation such as a bus, it does not distract from the fact that it still heavily affects these communities whose only option is to take the Bus.

SATISFACTION

SOURCE: MBTA SERVICE CUSTOMER SATISFACTION SURVEY

UNHAPPY WITH THE T

The graph shows that overall satisfaction with the T has been decreasing, and in 2023 dissatisfactory responses surpassed satisfactory ones since the data became available. It is possible that this will be the case again for 2024 as the year comes to an end.



WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

- Riders and users of Boston's public transportation systems are unhappy with their experiences
- Suggests change must be made somewhere to increase satisfaction with the T

SOLUTIONS

Overall, the Bus has the highest ridership numbers, serves the minority population the most, and has the highest number of delays as well as severity of delays. Overall satisfaction with the MBTA is decreasing, suggesting that Boston's public transportation system is not keeping up with the needs of Bostonians in everyday life today.

MOVING FORWARD:

1. **Provide fare-free access to public transportation for all individuals.**

Allow low income individuals better opportunities to travel. If all public transportation in Boston became free, everyone would be able to access every part of the city with more ease.

2. **Restructure, change, or add lines to combat dangerous or insufficient infrastructure.**

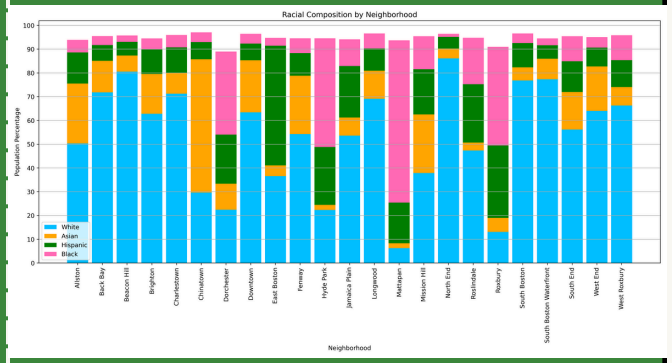
The city should update all the train cars and buses to ensure a good quality standard and minimize the amount of delays and issues caused by old vehicles Finally, they should implement new lines that can connect previously unconnected neighborhoods, specifically ones of lower income or higher minority percentage to those of higher income and lower minority percentage.

DEMOGRAPHICS

SOURCE: 2020 CENSUS FOR BOSTON - BOSTON NEIGHBORHOOD DATA - ANALYZE BOSTON

IMPORTANCE:

- Understanding demographics can lead to a more equitable T
- Work towards eliminating racism and classism in public goods
- Understand different needs of different communities



Fifteen of the demonstrated neighborhoods are at least 50% White. This also seems to correlate with the neighborhoods that have more transit options, like Back Bay and the North End. In contrast, Hyde Park, East Boston, and Roxbury have larger populations of Hispanic and Black people and simultaneously one, or no, subway lines to use.